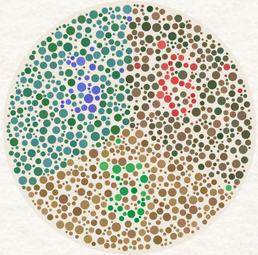
Goldfish

Looking together, seeing the same world?



ORIGIN / AN EXPLORATORY COLOUR STUDY

My colour-vision difference led me to collect six online reports on one device and create a three-part dot illustration.



L / Long-wave

M / Medium-wave

S / Short-wave

Do we see the same world?

Original illustration / No clinical validation / Machado 2009



01 / PRIVATE COLOUR EXPERIENCE / CONCEPT COLLAGE

Applauded.
But understood?



PROJECT / A NARRATIVE COLOUR-PUZZLE GAME

Players collect colours from life, paint, then erase and revise in response to other people. The painter still recognises the colours. He begins to doubt his own judgement.

THOUGHT EXPERIMENT / THE INVERTED SPECTRUM

Two people may use the same word for blue yet experience different colours. Shared words cannot let us exchange private experiences. Goldfish turns that distance into the tension between painting, feedback and revision.

DESIGN QUESTION

If choosing colours that please other people wins applause, does it bring us any closer to being understood?

CHAPTER 1 / COLOURS OF A DAY

Bring life into colour.

Colour brings a daily life into view. Familiar skies, leaves and fish make the painter's world feel natural.

THE START / LOW-COLOUR GAMEPLAY



READ / PROJECT ART

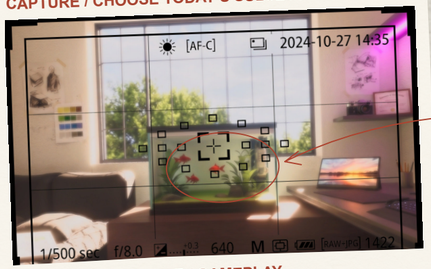
FISH CARE / CONCEPT

LIFE / INTERACTION BRINGS THE ROOM TO LIFE / GAMEPLAY



COLOURS COLLECTED FROM LIFE

CAPTURE / CHOOSE TODAY'S SUBJECT



Keep a moment from today.

PAINT / PAINT FROM LIFE / GAMEPLAY



01 / COLOUR TRIGGERS EVERYDAY ACTION

Collect colours from everyday objects and fill them back into the scene. Blue in the flowerpot makes him water it. Plants grow, the tank fills, and new colours and object states appear. A sparse, muted room gradually becomes a vivid home.

02 / BUILD A PERSON WITH A LIFE

Watering, keeping fish, reading, music, rest and phone calls give him a daily life. Players care for objects and maintain personal connections. Each colour acquires a history. Every mark on the canvas recalls something they have just experienced.

03 / TURN DAILY OBSERVATION INTO PAINTING

Each day, photograph an object in the room, then return to the computer to collect colours and paint. Publish the work and read its comments. At first this feels like a gentle colouring game: record daily life and trust that the painter sees the world as it is.

A smaller world.

Familiar colours. A hesitant hand.



CHAPTERS 2–3 / FROM ERASURE TO DOUBT

In Chapter 2, the painter only moves while the player erases. Colours nurtured in Chapter 1 become things to give up. Moving forward now means losing a life.

Comments call the painting lonely and cold. Remembering the life they nurtured, players begin to doubt their colours.

Players infer colour correspondences from comments, scenes and action outcomes, then test each guess by filling.

ERASE TO MOVE / GAMEPLAY

COMMENTS / GAMEPLAY

Life slips out of the picture.

CHAPTERS 3–4 / STUDIO SPACE CONCEPT

CHAPTER 4 / FIRST PERSON

After filling the unstable world, Chapter 4 unlocks a turning camera: players enter the city in first person.

Care, rest and closeness recede. Days shrink to painting and waiting. Yesterday's change for approval becomes today's life.

He still distinguishes blue from green. What changes is how he chooses. Before making a mark, he increasingly imagines how other people will judge it.

He knows the colours
His hand hesitates.

THE LAST

goldfish.

They stand close together.

BORN / PRESERVED / RECOLOURED

The red fish first appears through care and survives erasure. He finally changes its colour. The room falls silent, then breaks into applause.

A familiar hand. A different choice.

CHAPTER 5 / COLOUR REASSIGNMENT / CONCEPT

RED / BLUE

GREEN / PURPLE

YELLOW / CYAN

Their colour experiences remain apart.

CHAPTER 5 / PRACTISED RULES,

A FINAL DESCENT

The finale proposes removing prompts after repeated practice. Each fill moves the painter down a step. In Chapter 2, erasing moved him forward. Here, filling moves him down.

He finishes a painting he finds unbearably ugly, then hears applause.

EPILOGUE / VIEWING

FROM HER POINT OF VIEW

The painter sees the colours we know. Everyone else sees them differently. Through her eyes, his ugliest painting looks exactly like the one he once found most beautiful.



HER VIEW / COLOUR STUDY



HIS VIEW / COLOUR STUDY

They can never know what the other sees.

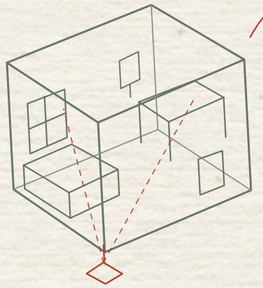
THE SAME FINAL PAINTING / TWO PERCEPTIONS

From colour to deduction

Let colour become a clue

Model the space. Render its light. Generate its states. Let colour become a clue.

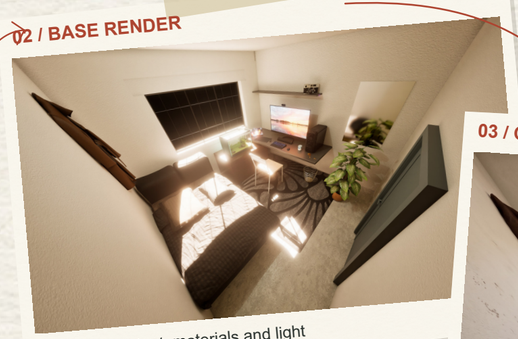
01 / Model a consistent space



Spatial relationship diagram

Fix the layout and camera for every scene variation.

02 / BASE RENDER



Establish content, materials and light

03 / GENERATED DETAIL AND ATMOSPHERE



03b / A DIFFERENT MOOD



Variations in time, light and atmosphere

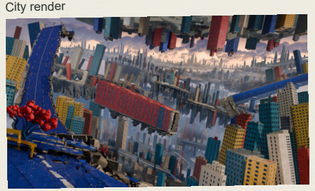
One space, many atmospheres.

The rendered base provides volume and light. Generated states contrast with the 2D anime characters.

3D clay model



City render



CH.4 / Fill, then enter

The city is fully modelled in 3D. Filling the world with colours that are now beyond control creates a chaotic city. Once filling is complete, the view suddenly becomes rotatable and shifts from the computer image to first person.

Core tools / Extract, fill, erase

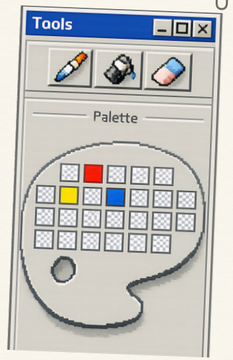
Three tools, layered rules

Extract / Collect colours from the scene

Fill / Apply a colour to a target

Erase / Remove paint and move forward

Project toolbar / detail



01 / Trigger actions

Fill the flowerpot with blue to make the painter walk over and water it.



02 / Choose where to go

Different colours applied before leaving lead to different scenes. Filling a target becomes a choice of where to go next.

03 / From intuitive filling to deduction

Read scene clues and reactions to infer how this world's colours map to reality. Test each guess by filling, turning colouring into deduction.

Observe clues → infer correspondences → test by filling

Wang Congrui / Lead Planner Zhang Jiajie / Gameplay & Technical Director Feng Kaiqi / Narrative, Art & Interaction